

Question:

A 5-year-old boy is brought to the physician by his mother because he does not “listen to her” anymore. The mother also reports that her son cannot concentrate on any tasks lasting longer than just a few minutes. Teachers at his preschool report that the patient is more active compared to other preschoolers, frequently interrupts or bothers other children, and is very forgetful. Last year the patient was expelled from another preschool for hitting his teacher and his classmates when he did not get what he wanted and for being disruptive during classes. He was born at term via vaginal delivery and has been healthy except for 3 episodes of acute otitis media at the age of 2 years. He has met all developmental milestones. His mother has major depressive disorder and his father has Graves' disease. He appears healthy and well nourished. Examination shows that the patient does not seem to listen when spoken to directly. The remainder of the examination shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most appropriate next step in treatment?

Answer Choices:

- A. Behavior therapy
- B. Methimazole
- C. Fluoxetine
- D. Hearing aids

Reasoning + Answer:

<answer> A. Behavior therapy </answer>

<think> Reasoning process :

- 1 . The patient's symptoms of not listening to his mother , difficulty concentrating , being more active , interrupting others , and being forgetful are characteristic of Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD).
- 2 . The patient's history of being expelled from preschool due to behavioral issues and hitting others also supports this diagnosis .
- 3 . The patient's developmental milestones have been met , and there is no indication of any medical or neurological disorders that could be causing his symptoms .
- 4 . The family history of major depressive disorder and Graves ' disease is not directly relevant to the patient's current symptoms .
- 5 . The patient appears healthy and well-nourished , which reduces the likelihood of any underlying medical conditions contributing to his symptoms .
- 6 . Hearing aids are not indicated as there is no indication of hearing loss .
- 7 . Methimazole is a medication used to treat hyperthyroidism , which is not suggested by any symptoms or examination findings in this patient .
- 8 . Fluoxetine is an antidepressant medication , but it is not typically used as a first-line treatment for ADHD .

Given the patient's symptoms and examination findings , behavior therapy is the most appropriate next step in treatment . This may include behavioral modification techniques , such as positive reinforcement , and medication if necessary .